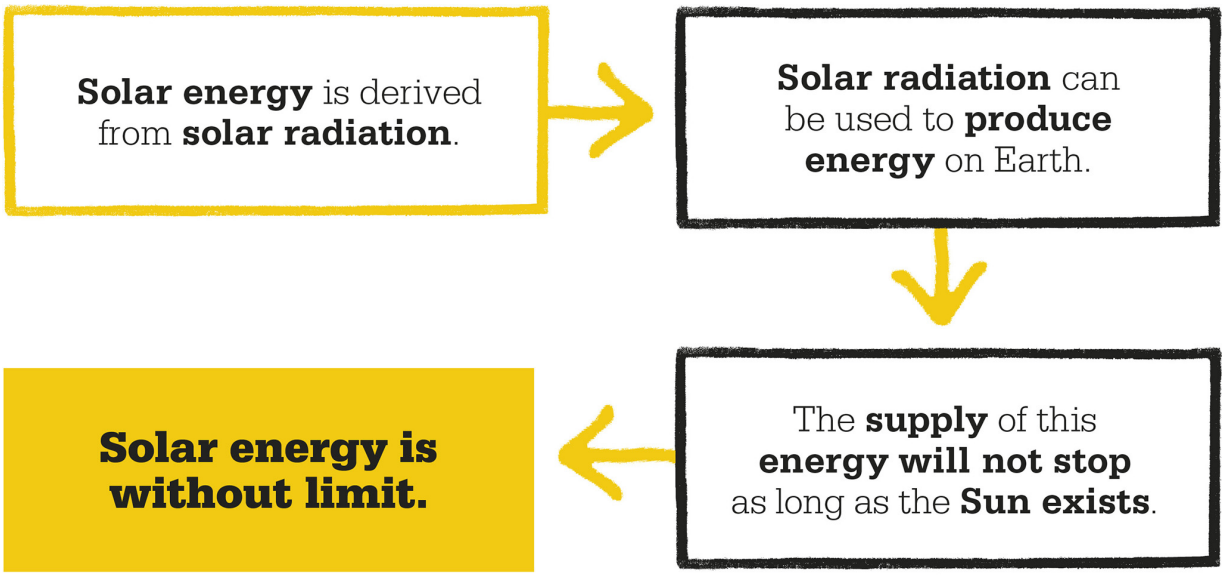


Read accessible description

Wind power

For more than 2,000 years, people have built windmills to pump water and grind grain. Today, wind farms onshore and offshore account for around 8 percent of total electricity produced globally. A wind turbine's huge blades turn around a rotor attached to a main shaft, which spins a generator to produce electricity. Wind power is now the leading area of energy growth in Europe, the US, and Canada. Almost 60 percent of Denmark's energy comes from wind, while in the UK it is 28 percent, in the US 10 percent, and in India 4.2 percent. This renewable energy source is growing rapidly in many countries around the world.

It is only economic to build wind farms where there is regular wind, however, so the potential is not evenly spread around the globe. Offshore wind is generally stronger and more regular than onshore. Floating turbines can generate wind energy far offshore, unlike seabed-anchored wind turbines, which have to be sited in shallow water close to the coastline.